

Realme has added many AI features and with all the new camera hardware and features as well, an upgrade in the chipset was the least one could ask for.

I remember using the Realme 12 Pro+ and giving a feedback on the fact that the smartphone takes a while to process images. Now, with these upgrades, I was expecting this to only get worse. And while it hasn't gotten worse, it hasn't even improved. The Realme 13 Pro+ again takes a while to process images and for someone who likes to capture the moment, this actually captures the next moment. The image processing I found to be slow, especially in portraits.

Even in benchmarks the Realme 13 Pro+ doesn't do anything groundbreaking. The smartphone gets decimated in front of competitors like the Poco F6, OnePlus Nord 4, or the Honor 200. And while the smartphone gave me no issues in terms of day-to-day usage, the gaming isn't as smooth as on many other devices in this price range.

I played a lot of Call of Duty: Mobile on this smartphone and at times, I did experience a slight stutter or frame drops while gaming on the Realme 13 Pro+. And while the performance is just average, the heating is very well managed. Even during hour-long gaming sessions on the Realme 13 Pro+, it never got so warm that it made me uncomfortable while holding the smartphone. I have experienced much worse heating on smartphones that claim to have the largest vapour cooling chamber in the segment, so this is great.

So yes, in terms of performance my experience was nothing more than average. With the addition of AI features and newer camera hardware, at least a Snapdragon 7 Gen 3 chipset on the Realme 13 Pro+ would have done the job right. While day-to-day it is good, in benchmarks and in gaming, the experience wasn't very premium to say the least. Even the camera, which is the highlight of this device takes its own sweet time to process images and details.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

Now, while the performance isn't great, the battery makes up for it. We are getting a bigger 5,200mAh battery with the Realme 13 Pro+ along with 80W fast charging. And yes, the bigger battery has, in this case, made a difference. The Realme 13 Pro+ did well in almost all our battery tests. The smartphone only lost four percent of its battery while playing Call of Duty: Mobile on the highest graphics and four percent while watching a YouTube video for 30 minutes. Using GPS for one hour made the Realme 13 Pro+ lose about 6 percent of the battery, and in our video loop test, it lasted 1022 minutes or just above 17 hours, which is again outstanding.

Charging is also super fast. We are getting 80W fast charging with the Realme 13 Pro+ and in my charging test, it charged from 0 to 100 percent in just 48 minutes. That is brilliant and will definitely work for a user like myself who only gets reminded of charging their phone when they are about to leave for the day.

CAMERA

Coming to the camera, here we are seeing one of the biggest upgrades in terms of the hardware. This time, Realme has used the new Sony LYT 701 primary shooter and a Sony LYT600 periscope telephoto shooter which enables 3x optical zoom. We are also getting an 8MP wide angle shooter, which is the same as last time.

Now, the camera quality has improved. The images look very detailed and the dynamic range on outdoor shots is outstanding. I also see that the sensor is taking in more light, which makes for brighter images and better low light shots.

The portraits are also very good with the Realme 13 Pro+. The edge detection is good and the background blur does a very good job in terms of making the subject stand out. But here again, the experience doesn't remain as snappy since the processing takes time. For the Realme 13 Pro+ to process the portraits, it takes a nice 3-4 seconds.

And while that isn't something I mind, the fact that it captures the next frame as compared to what you clicked in the viewfinder is what takes away from the experience a little bit.

But overall, the camera is good. The images are detailed, colours don't look too artificial and you can create some very good professional looking shots with this camera is what matters. Furthermore, we are getting a telephoto shooter and 6x in-sensor zoom makes it also fairly fun to play around with. Good camera but slow processing.

VERDICT

So overall, the Realme 13 Pro+ is a good smartphone. It has a nice design that will work for many users. Although we are getting the now overdone circular camera, it is something many people prefer and goes well with the whole idea of a camera-centric smartphone.

However, there are issues. Now, while the Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 chipset is pretty capable, it hasn't really resulted in an upgrade of the performance. And while most of my usage was absolutely seamless, I just can't get over the fact that this smartphone, which is made for cameras, doesn't allow me to capture the moment (it ends up capturing the next moment).

Furthermore, the software remains a pain point. There are bloatware apps and the process to set up your phone and get on with using it is just so long and so redundant. It is a long process of declining never-ending pop-ups and permissions while setting up a device. So yes, while it justifies the Rs 30,000 value in one way or the other, I would not recommend the Realme 13 Pro+ as the best smartphone in this range.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Memory: 8 GB RAM and 256 GB ROM | Display: 17.02 cm (6.7 inch) Full HD+ | Battery: 5200 mAh | Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7s Gen2 Processor | Cameras: 50MP + 8MP + 50MP and 32MP Front Camera

CONTACT

Company: realme | Phone: 1800 102 2777 | Email: Wed Form | Website: <https://www.realme.com/in/>